

REST resources can have multiple presentations (e.g. JSON or XML) as different clients can request different representation.

The mechanism for selecting a correct representation is known as content negotiation.

By default it uses application/json (unless modified)

Content negotiation allows clients to request specific content type(s) to be returned by the server.

With content negotiation, we enable a single endpoint to support different types of resource representations

Content Negotiation Strategies

Content Negotiation can be done in following ways

1. Using Path Extension This has the highest preference. In the request we specify the required response type using the extension like .json, .xml or .txt.

2. Using url parameter This has the second highest preference. In the request we specify the required response type using the url parameter like format=xml or format=json.

3. Using Accept Headers (request header) When making a request using HTTP we specify required response by setting the Accept header property.

Another important point regarding conversion

As we know , SC (using Jackson=Spring boot's default vendor for marshalling n un marshalling support) It uses :

getters : During serialization(=marshalling , java---> json)

setters : During de-serialization (=un marshalling , json --> java)

Default access : BOTH (i.e allows - read(getter) n write(setter))

To customize the names of serialization n de-ser props

@JsonProperty : Jackson annotation

eg : @JsonProperty(value="mesg")

private String message;

How to control the property/field access during serialization/de-serialization ?

@JsonProperty(access = Access.WRITE_ONLY) : It means that the property may only be written for de-serialization(skipped during ser.)

@JsonProperty(access = Access.READ_ONLY) : It means that the property may only be read for serialization(skipped during de-ser)